



What actually went right last week

The 5 stories readers chose, week of 28 September

Zoom out: in 1990 the ozone hole was growing every year. It is now the smallest since records began.



Not the event itself · USDA NRCS Texas · Public domain · Wikimedia Commons

A farmer turned 70 acres of his Oregon barley farm into a wetland, and 200 bird species came back.

What it proves: Farmland can be given back to nature by one person deciding to do it.



Britain's smallest wild pig is back: a breeding programme has taken the pygmy hog from six known animals to 194.

What it proves: A species written off in the 1990s can be rebuilt when someone keeps at it for thirty years.

97 percent

A single injection cut inherited high cholesterol by 97 percent for 48 weeks in an early trial.

What it proves: A condition that needed daily pills for life may become a once-a-year appointment.



Not the event itself · MM2sp · Public domain · Wikimedia Commons

Norway launched its first orbital rocket from Andoya, the first from mainland Europe.

What it proves: Space access no longer belongs only to the countries that started early.

A six-year-old in Cologne recognised her family's stolen car in traffic and led police to it.

What it proves: Paying attention is a skill that does not wait for adulthood.

Read any of them

Every link is in the post text, just above this deck.

1. The Better India
2. Mongabay
3. BBC
4. Euronews
5. 20 Minuten

“The best way to find out if you can trust somebody is to trust them.”

Ernest Hemingway

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